

Quebec Picks a Party That Wants to Leave Canada

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Quebec is a **province** in Canada. On Monday, voters there held an election. The Parti Québécois, or PQ, is expected to lead a **minority government**. That means it won the most seats, but not more than half, so it needs help from other parties.

The PQ wants Quebec to become **independent** from the rest of Canada. It has promised a public vote, called a **referendum**, on that idea. The PQ has not led Quebec since 2014.

Its leader, Paul St-Pierre Plamondon, will become Quebec's **premier**. That job is a bit like a U.S. governor. He promised to be "the **premier** of everyone in Quebec." He has said a **referendum** would come only after President Donald Trump leaves office.

It is not clear how a **referendum** could happen, because the other parties are against independence.

Canada's Prime Minister Mark Carney congratulated the new leader.

Word Treasure

province -- A province is a part of Canada with its own government, a bit like a U.S. state.

minority government -- A minority government is led by the party with the most seats, but less than half.

independent -- Independent means being your own country and making your own rules.

referendum -- A referendum is a vote where people decide one big question.

premier -- A premier is the leader of a province in Canada.

Background you need

Canada is made up of provinces, and each one chooses its own government in elections. Quebec is a province where most people speak French, and some people there want it to be its own country.

In a referendum, people vote yes or no on one big question.

Break it down

WHO: The Parti Québécois and its leader, Paul St-Pierre Plamondon

WHAT: The PQ is expected to lead a minority government after Monday's election

WHERE: Quebec, a province in Canada

WHY: Voters chose the PQ, a party that wants Quebec to be independent from Canada

Why it matters

Quebec is a close neighbor of the United States, and its choice could change how Canada works together as one country.

Test what you remember

1. What is Quebec?

- ☐ (A) A country in Europe
- ☐ (B) A river in Mexico
- ☐ (C) A province in Canada
- ☐ (D) A city in the United States

2. Which party is expected to lead Quebec's government?

- ☐ (A) The Green Party
- ☐ (B) The Parti Québécois
- ☐ (C) The Coalition Avenir Québec
- ☐ (D) No party

3. What does the PQ want for Quebec?

- ☐ (A) To join the United States
- ☐ (B) To have no government
- ☐ (C) To change its name
- ☐ (D) To become independent from Canada

4. What is a referendum?

- ☐ (A) A kind of tax
- ☐ (B) A new law about schools
- ☐ (C) A sports game
- ☐ (D) A public vote on one idea

5. Who will become Quebec's premier?

- ☐ (A) Mark Carney
- ☐ (B) Donald Trump
- ☐ (C) A king
- ☐ (D) Paul St-Pierre Plamondon

6. Why is it unclear how a referendum could happen?

- ☐ (A) It is against the law everywhere
- ☐ (B) There is no money
- ☐ (C) The other parties are against independence
- ☐ (D) Nobody wants to vote

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: D 4: D 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Paul St-Pierre Plamondon:** He wants independence and promised to be the premier of everyone in Quebec.
2. **Other parties:** They are against independence.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):